

Happy Geek Christmas!

Some folks all over the world are busy making LED Christmas trees. Quite a fun idea worth trying

Flying high

Boeing's 787 Dreamliner is in the air. The behemoth is an 80 per cent composite material aircraft, with 35 tonnes of carbon-fibre reinforced plastic



LCD cleaning kit (Rs. 40)

People often poke their friends about the possibility of getting questionable stains on their LCDs from watching questionable content. If it does ever happen, you can always use this box set which comes with a soft cloth which is a 80:20 mix of polyester and polyimide – whatever that means. There's a liquid spray, that works quite well, and a soft brush that has a miniature hand at one end for some reason.

Bluetooth (Rs. 100)

If your laptop doesn't have Bluetooth, then a dongle is a must. This one is the smallest one we've seen so far. Let it occupy a spot on your laptop and you have Bluetooth connectivity. Even for your desktop PC it's always nice to have another means of connectivity right? Connect to headsets, mobile phones cameras just about anything. On Windows 7, the device installed automatically and there was no trouble to have it up and running in no time.



Gaming Mat (Rs. 170)

Long cylindrical packaging and a name a name like PlayMat, arouses a strange suspicion. Turns out it's a gaming mat. And a very good one at that. Not that it's a testament to the quality but the company that make this, UltraPRO has website too and seems to have a rather large range of products. The mat offers a huge playing surface and has a very nice print of a dragon. The mouse glides smoothly over its traction happy surface. We'd say it offers about 70 per cent of the performance of products offered by the likes of Razer and EverGlide, at about 15 per cent of the price. Sweet deal isn't it?



CD and lens cleaner (Rs. 50)

Many users write in about how they can clean their CDs and DVDs. Well here's something you can try. Along with badly translated Chinese instructions, this kit comes with a CD VCD cleaning fluid, soft cotton brush, a separate DVD cleaning fluid to be used with the lens cleaner CD. The lens cleaning CD has two brushes with soft bristles on the reading surface. The fluids are odourless, colourless, non-viscus, and non-soapy. We wouldn't be surprised if the bottles are just filled with water. The lens cleaning disk just about saved this one from the avoid list.

Multi USB kit (Rs. 90)

The central device has a auto retracting cable that basically acts as an extension to your USB port. The six other thingies let you connect to all sorts of devices. The connectors include Micro-B, Mini B, Type B and many other standards. A must have for any self respecting geek. [Psst – here's a tip - Combine this with the USB adapter to make your own universal charger.]



Notebook lock (Rs. 75)

It's not just wallets that get pinched these days. With notebooks getting smaller and lighter, and netbooks protruding out of large pockets, any help we can get to safeguard our gizmos is appreciated. This little device fits into the Kensington lock slot on your notebook/netbook, and can prevent someone with sleight of hand walking away with your precious baby. Especially recommended for those who go to LAN parties, or waste time at coffee shops, pretending to work. Just remember to hook the other end to something that's immovable – and not your briefcase, or you'll end up losing more than you bargained for.

